

Ówànńbè: Brand Story & Identity

The strongest direction for Ówànńbè is to make the **first letter itself the symbol of the brand**. Rather than placing a generic party icon beside the name, the opening **Ó** should become a

sculptural, gele-inspired mark. The characters can bring the celebration to life, while the logo remains recognizable even when used without them.

The visual direction should feel unmistakably Nigerian, culturally grounded, colourful, and premium, without looking like a generic event-planning company.

1. The Brand Story

Ówàńbè

More Than Parties. It's Our Heritage.

Some celebrations are too important to leave to chance.

They bring families together, honour milestones, preserve traditions, create memories, and support the people whose creativity makes every occasion extraordinary.

Ówàńbè is built around this belief: celebration is more than an event. It is culture, community, creativity, and commerce coming together.

We are building a modern home for Yoruba celebrations, connecting people with the vendors, creatives, services, and cultural knowledge they need to bring their occasions to life.

From the first idea to the final guest, Ówàńbè helps people plan with confidence, discover trusted providers, coordinate the details, and spend less time managing logistics. Our AI-powered assistance makes the work easier, while people remain in control of the decisions that matter.

But our ambition goes beyond helping people throw better parties.

We want to make the celebration economy more visible, connected, and accessible. We want talented vendors to be discovered for their work, cultural practitioners to receive greater recognition, and local businesses to find more opportunities to grow.

Because behind every gele, every carefully prepared outfit, every beautifully arranged table, every beat of the talking drum, and every shared plate of food is a person, a craft, and a tradition worth celebrating.

Ówàńbè brings these worlds together.

Rooted in culture. Connected by community. Made easier with technology.

Ówàńbè. Your Celebration. Our Culture. Powered by AI.

This is the foundational story. As the product matures, it can be adapted into a shorter homepage story, an investor narrative, and a vendor-facing mission.

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2. The Logo Concept: The Gele Ó

The central idea

Turn the Ó into a gele.

The opening letter should be the most distinctive part of the identity. It should work as a wordmark feature, a standalone app icon, and a recognizable brand stamp.

I would build the logo around three elements:

A. The Gele Ó

- The circular body of the capital **Ó** forms the foundation.
- Its upper curves extend into layered folds inspired by a beautifully tied Yoruba gele.
- The acute accent above the Ó becomes an intentional part of the headwrap design, not a detached decorative mark.
- The folds use a small number of confident colour transitions rather than dozens of tiny details.
- At large sizes, subtle textile-inspired linework can add richness. At small sizes, the design simplifies into a clear silhouette.

The goal is for someone to recognize the gele-shaped O even before reading the brand name.

B. The Ówàńbè Characters

I would introduce three primary illustrated characters, each with a distinct silhouette and personality.

Character	Visual direction	Brand role
The Celebrant	A striking gele, elegant traditional attire, confident posture	Represents personal milestones and the joy of dressing for an occasion
The Host	An agbada-inspired silhouette, distinctive fila, warm expression	Represents hospitality, family, and bringing people together
The Creative	A distinctive outfit and expressive pose, with room to evolve into different cultural and contemporary styles	Represents the vendors, designers, creatives, and people who make celebrations possible

These should be designed as an **illustration family**, not as three unrelated mascots.

Their faces, proportions, outlines, and rendering style should be consistent. Their outfits, colours, accessories, and poses should distinguish them.

Over time, the character family can expand to represent different generations, styles of celebration, creative professions, and communities. Yoruba culture should not be reduced to one stereotypical look.

C. The Wordmark

The wordmark should read exactly:

Ówàńbè

The tonal marks matter. The logo must preserve the spelling and diacritics exactly as supplied. Do not allow a designer or image generator to silently replace them with plain Latin characters.

I recommend a custom wordmark with a confident, editorial serif or a carefully customized display typeface. The letterforms should feel expressive and celebratory without becoming difficult to read.

The characters should support the wordmark, not compete with it.

Three logo variations

1. **Primary logo:** The colourful gele Ó, custom Ówàńbè wordmark, and the three celebration characters.
2. **Compact logo:** The wordmark with the gele Ó and no characters.
3. **App icon:** The standalone gele Ó, simplified for small screens and favicons.

The app icon is especially important. If the full character illustration is too complicated to recognize at a small size, it should not be used as the primary app icon.

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3. Proposed Brand Kit

These are the recommended starting specifications, not final production-ready assets. The colours should be tested against actual screens, print materials, and accessibility requirements.

Colour palette

The identity should capture the visual abundance of Yoruba celebrations without making every component compete for attention.

Colour	Hex	Purpose

Royal Aubergine	`#48245F`	Primary brand colour; sophistication and depth
Celebration Gold	`#F7B500`	Highlights, accents, celebratory details
Yoruba Blue	`#0088A8`	Digital interactions and secondary accents
Emerald Green	`#087D65`	Cultural richness and supporting illustrations
Vibrant Coral	`#E63946`	Energy, calls to action, and expressive details
Aso-Oke Pink	`#D81B8D`	Character accents and decorative applications
Warm Ivory	`#FFF7E9`	Primary light background
Deep Charcoal	`#211D24`	Body text and dark interfaces

Important: Purple and warm ivory should anchor the system. Gold, blue, green, coral, and pink should bring the celebration to life in controlled combinations.

Using every colour at full intensity in every interface would make the product feel chaotic. The brand can be exuberant while its software remains clear and easy to use.

Typography

Display typeface: Playfair Display

Use for expressive campaign headlines, editorial storytelling, and selected brand statements.

Interface typeface: Montserrat

Use for navigation, buttons, forms, dashboards, vendor listings, and general product interfaces.

Implementation guidance: Both are available through widely used font libraries. Before production, check the exact weights required and bundle the selected fonts appropriately.

Graphic language

The supporting visual system should draw inspiration from:

- The folds and sculptural shapes of gele.
- The geometry and textures of aso-oke.
- The movement and rhythm associated with celebration.
- Beads, fans, and other culturally relevant accessories.
- The expressive colour combinations found at Yoruba celebrations.

Use these as references for original shapes and patterns rather than copying sacred, ceremonial, or community-specific motifs without research.

Illustration style

The characters should have:

- Distinct silhouettes that remain recognizable in monochrome.
- Expressive but tasteful facial features.
- Carefully rendered traditional clothing and accessories.
- Consistent proportions and linework.
- Strong colour blocking and controlled detail.
- A balance of warmth, sophistication, and playfulness.

Avoid generic cartoon faces, exaggerated caricatures, random cultural accessories, and visual clichés that reduce people to costumes.

Brand voice

Ówàńbè should sound:

- Warm, welcoming, and confident.
- Culturally aware without being exclusionary.
- Practical when helping people plan.
- Celebratory when telling stories.
- Respectful when representing traditions and communities.
- Clear about what its AI can do and what still requires human decisions.

Tagline

My recommended primary tagline is:

Your Celebration. Our Culture. Powered by AI.

For more emotional campaigns, use:

More Than Parties. It's Our Heritage.

For product communications, use:

Plan. Source. Celebrate.

Each serves a different purpose. The first communicates the overall proposition, the second expresses the brand's emotional foundation, and the third gives people a memorable action sequence.

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4. Prompt for Gemini to Create a More Refined Logo

I would use Gemini to explore the design, but I would not rely on a generated image alone for the final logo. Image generators can distort typography, miss tonal marks, and introduce inconsistencies into character designs. The final logo should be recreated as a clean, editable vector.

Here is a prompt you can copy directly.

Act as an elite brand identity designer, Yoruba cultural visual researcher, character designer, and specialist in scalable vector logo systems.

Your assignment is to develop a distinctive, commercially viable logo and visual identity for **Ówàńbè**, a technology-enabled celebration-commerce brand rooted in Yoruba celebration culture.

1. Brand Context

Ówàńbè helps people plan celebrations, discover and coordinate trusted vendors, manage event logistics, and use AI assistance to bring their occasions to life.

The wider ambition is to make the celebration economy more connected and visible, create opportunities for vendors and cultural practitioners, and preserve the cultural knowledge that gives celebrations their meaning.

This is not a generic event-planning application. It is a culturally grounded brand that combines celebration, community, commerce, and technology.

Brand personality:

- Colourful
- Grand
- Expressive
- Warm
- Culturally grounded

- Contemporary
- Confident
- Premium
- Inclusive
- Human

The identity must communicate Yoruba celebration energy without looking outdated, stereotypical, overly ornamental, or like a generic wedding company.

2. Exact Brand Name

The brand name must be written exactly:

Ówàńbè

Preserve every character and diacritic:

- Capital Ó
- Lowercase w
- Lowercase à
- Lowercase ń
- Lowercase b
- Lowercase è

Do not replace the name with Owanbe, O'wambè, Owanbé, or any other variation.

Do not invent alternative spellings.

If your image-generation system cannot reliably render the exact text, create a clean wordmark placeholder and explicitly instruct the designer to replace it with the exact text using editable vector typography. Do not present an incorrect spelling as final artwork.

3. Core Logo Concept: The Gele Ó

The central creative direction is to transform the capital letter Ó into a distinctive symbol inspired by a beautifully tied Yoruba gele.

The letter itself must remain recognizable as an O.

Design the upper contours of the O as sculptural, layered gele folds. Integrate the acute accent above Ó into the composition so it feels intentionally connected to the headwrap, while preserving the typographic identity of the letter.

The symbol should feel:

- Elegant and sculptural
- Instantly recognizable
- Distinctive at small sizes
- Beautiful in monochrome
- Suitable for an app icon
- Appropriate for premium digital and physical applications

Use a restrained number of flowing shapes. Avoid excessive folds, tiny patterns, gradients that weaken reproduction, and decorative elements that obscure the letter.

The result must be a clever fusion of typography and cultural form, not a generic O with a separate headwrap pasted on top.

4. Celebration Characters

Create a coherent family of three original illustrated characters inspired by the energy, clothing, and personalities associated with Yoruba celebrations.

Character 1: The Celebrant

- A confident, expressive figure wearing a beautifully sculpted gele.
- Traditional attire inspired by iro-and-buba, interpreted with contemporary sophistication.
- Jewellery and textile details should be deliberate, not excessive.
- The character should communicate joy, elegance, and individuality.

Character 2: The Host

- A confident figure wearing an agbada-inspired outfit and a distinctive fila.
- Warm expression and a welcoming presence.
- Clothing should communicate dignity and hospitality.
- Use a different silhouette and colour balance from the first character.

Character 3: The Creative

- A distinctive celebratory personality representing the people who make events possible.
- Contemporary but culturally grounded styling.
- Strong silhouette, expressive pose, and a distinct colour combination.
- The character should be able to represent the broader creative and vendor community.

All three characters must have consistent illustration proportions, rendering techniques, and visual quality.

They should feel like members of one recognizable brand universe.

Avoid generic stock illustrations, exaggerated caricatures, overly childish proportions, and stereotypical depictions of Yoruba people.

Do not add cultural objects merely as decoration. Research visual references and use them thoughtfully.

The characters should enhance the logo, not overwhelm the wordmark.

5. Colour System

Build the identity around this proposed palette:

Royal Aubergine: #48245F
Celebration Gold: #F7B500
Yoruba Blue: #0088A8
Emerald Green: #087D65
Vibrant Coral: #E63946
Aso-Oke Pink: #D81B8D
Warm Ivory: #FFF7E9
Deep Charcoal: #211D24

Use Royal Aubergine as the principal brand anchor, Warm Ivory as the main light background, and the remaining colours selectively in the gele, character clothing, and graphic accents.

The colour application should feel rich and joyful, not random.

Create a version that works on both light and dark backgrounds.

Also create a strictly monochrome version that retains the full silhouette and remains legible without colour.

6. Wordmark and Typography

Develop a distinctive wordmark for Ówàńbè.

Explore an expressive, contemporary serif or a customized display typeface. The letterforms should feel premium, memorable, and warm.

Maintain excellent readability.

Pay particular attention to:

- The proportions of the O.
- The relationship between the gele-inspired O and the rest of the wordmark.
- The placement and legibility of every diacritic.

- Consistent spacing.
- A harmonious balance between the wordmark and the illustrated characters.

Do not let the characters replace letters in the name.

7. Required Deliverables

Create a polished identity presentation containing:

A. Primary logo:
The gele-inspired Ó, exact Ówàńbè wordmark, and the three celebration characters.

B. Secondary logo:
The wordmark with the gele Ó, without the characters.

C. App icon:
A simplified gele Ó that remains recognizable at 24–48 pixels.

D. Monochrome logo:
A one-colour version suitable for printing, stamps, embroidery, and restricted-colour applications.

E. Character sheet:
Three individual characters shown separately, with their names, colour palettes, and consistent illustration styles.

F. Colour palette:
Display every colour with its exact hexadecimal value.

G. Typography system:
Show headline and interface typeface recommendations, including example text.

H. Graphic language:
Develop original, restrained pattern elements inspired by gele folds and researched Yoruba textile geometry.

I. Application mockups:
Show how the identity might appear on a mobile application, event banner, vendor badge, packaging, and social media profile.

8. Visual Quality Requirements

The identity must look like work from a world-class independent brand studio.

Prioritize:

- Originality over decoration.
- Distinctiveness over complexity.
- Cultural integrity over superficial cultural references.
- Scalability over fine detail.
- Consistency across all assets.
- Legibility and practical reproduction.
- A premium finish without losing the joyful character of Yoruba celebrations.

The primary logo should remain strong when reduced, printed in one colour, or used without its characters.

Do not use stock-logo conventions, generic party balloons, champagne glasses, confetti explosions, or generic event-planning symbols.

Do not place the logo inside a mockup as a substitute for presenting the actual logo clearly.

9. Output and Quality Control

Present the logo concepts against a plain, neutral background before showing applications.

Show the primary logo large enough to evaluate the gele-inspired Ó and the exact wordmark.

Check all lettering carefully. Never claim that generated lettering is production-ready if any character or diacritic is incorrect.

Keep the identity system internally consistent. The characters, typography, colours, and patterns must feel like parts of the same brand.

If you can generate editable vector output, provide clean SVGs with properly grouped paths and shapes. Otherwise, produce high-quality visual concepts and give precise instructions for recreating them in a vector design tool.

The final result should make Ówàńbè recognizable even without its full name: a gele-inspired Ó that becomes an enduring symbol of Yoruba celebration, community, creativity, and cultural pride.

5. My Recommendation Before Finalizing

There is one strategic choice I would make now: **do not make the three characters the only recognizable logo.**

Characters are valuable for storytelling, onboarding, social content, campaigns, and vendor education. However, they can make a primary logo too complicated for a mobile product.

I would establish the gele Ó as the enduring brand symbol, the wordmark as the primary name recognition asset, and the characters as a distinctive illustration system that brings the brand to life.

The brand can then feel grand and expressive on an event banner, refined on a vendor's badge, and instantly recognizable on a phone screen.

The next design step: generate three variations of the gele Ó before finalizing the character family. Compare a sculptural, layered gele; a more geometric, textile-inspired gele; and a minimalist, contemporary gele. Choose the strongest symbol first, then build the wordmark and characters around it.

That will give Ówàńbè a better chance of becoming a recognizable brand rather than simply a colourful illustration of a party.